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Week 7 Lit Example Worksheet

MACBETH: APPEARANCE OF PROOF AND PRESSURE

Purpose: Apply Week 7's Whately method to *Macbeth*. Diagnose arguments that look stronger than they are.

Directions: Use the Lit Example Reader. Do not retell the plot. Separate emotional force from logical force.

Part 1: Lady Macbeth's Pressure

Question 1.1

What conclusion is Lady Macbeth pressing on Macbeth in Passage 1? State it in one clear sentence.

Part 1 Q1

Question 1.2

What gives her speech its appearance of proof? Name at least two pressure moves in the language.

Part 1 Q2

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Part 2: Defect in the Reasoning

Question 2.1

Is the main failure in Lady Macbeth's pressure a false claim, a bad inference, or both? Explain.

Part 2 Q1

Question 2.2

Explain the difference between emotional force and logical force using this exchange.

Part 2 Q2

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Part 3: The Plan and the Settlement

Question 3.1

In Passage 2, what does Lady Macbeth's cover-up plan actually support, and what does it fail to prove?

Part 3 Q1

Question 3.2

When Macbeth says "I am settled," has he gained proof that the murder is right, confidence that they can hide it, or both? Explain.

Part 3 Q2

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Part 4: Fallacy Autopsy

Question 4.1

Perform a full fallacy autopsy on Lady Macbeth's persuasion of Macbeth: (1) conclusion, (2) apparent proof, (3) defect, (4) repaired or narrowed claim that would be fairer.

Part 4 Q1

Question 4.2

In one paragraph, explain why a speech can feel conclusive without proving its point, using these Macbeth passages.

Part 4 Q2